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LARGE Steps Into Sorrow

large A TwoPart Exploration Arc for *Fate’s Edge*

Tiers IIIV — 69 sessions — Philosophy puzzles, planar hazards, rival expeditions

rule

What This Is

A complete arc that begins on the legendary **Bridge of a Thousand Steps** and descends into the shadowrift metropolis of **SevenSorrows**. It emphasizes ¶osition play, failforward travel, environmental puzzles, and escalating rival pressure. The finale centers on the **Orrery of Lost Worlds**.

At a Glance

tem **Part I The Bridge of a Thousand Steps** (Tier II): Each step poses a moral riddle or personal reckoning; failure costs gear, memory, or time instead of lives. tem **Part II The Sunken City of SevenSorrows** (Tier IIIV): A thematic “district crawl” where sorrowaspect challenges unlock the Orrery.

System Notes. ¶osition sets your approach to hazards and social scenes; treat s as codified outcomes (keys, escorts, permits) that reframe ¶osition before rolling. Timers pace rivals, environment, and dread. When 1s appear, spend §B to twist the route, split the party, or advance a rival *rail*. Keep dice scarce by rewarding preparation.

Core Tools for the GM

Position DV Quick Reference

0.5em

	rule	Position	Typical DV	Examples of Fic- tional Ad- van- tage
	rule	Dominant	+2	Correct an- swer in hand; guide spir- its fa- vor you; ri- val stalled.
linewidth		Controlled	+3	Stable foot- ing; time to think; rel- e- vant lore or to- kens.
		Desperate	+4 or more	Rift surge; taboo breached; ri- val in your face.
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Suggested DV Ranges by Part

rule	Part	Common DV Range	Notes
rule I: Bridge		35	Late steps es- ca- late; spend Di- a- monds to re- duce DV for one team mem- ber.
linewidthII: SevenSorrows	46		Districts start at DV 4; the Or- rery be- gins at DV 6, drop- ping per solved sor- row.
tomrule			

SB Spend Menus

Bridge of a Thousand Steps

tem A step misinterprets intent; reroll at higher DV or pay a *Toll* (gear lost, memory tithe, or Dread +1). tem A crosswind of whispers moves a stone; party splits unless someone anchors with a confession. tem Another traveler manifests (echo of a PC's past) and demands to “walk

with you” as a complication.

Seven Sorrows

tem **Sorrowecho** duplicates a PC’s last mistake in public, worsening crowd position. tem **Rival expeditions** get ahead; tick Rival Lead+1 and close a route. tem **Rift surge** changes district aspect; DV +1 until checked by a rite or offering.

Rivals (Use 12)

tem **Black Ferrule Company** mercenary treasurerights. *Edge:* anchors, explosives. *Tell:* iron ferrules on boots. tem **Order of the Last Dawn** apocalyptic zeal. *Edge:* sacramental wards. *Tell:* ashsmudged fingers. tem **Gulls of the Chart** scholarcartographers. *Edge:* partial maps, clever shortcuts. *Tell:* saltink stains.

Create a Rival Progress⁶ and a Rival Lead³. Each SB you spend can tick one; PCs can reduce them with victories or bribes.

Part I The Bridge of a Thousand Steps (Tier II)

Frame

The bridge is not continuous: each stone appears when a riddle is answered *in deed or word*. Steps draw questions from the travelers’ regrets and values. Failing a step means cost, not death.

Crossing Timer

Use a Crossing⁸ to track fatigue and conditions. Each setback ticks it. On fill, an enforced *camponair* scene occurs: safety at the price of a Toll.

Approaches

Each step can be met by different approaches; match to playbooks and talents.

tem *Lore/Insight*: reason, recall, pattern. tem *Resolve/Spirit*: confession, vow, acceptance. tem *Athletics/Wits*: leap, countergust, lateral thinking. tem *Magic/Rites*: sanctify a step, bind a doubt, mirror a truth.

Step Table (Roll or Choose)

rule	d6	Prompt	Consequence (on Cost/Miss)
rule 1		“When I promise still mi- binds nor you item when you none brought watch?”	lose im- press; it sinks into the air.
2		“What Memory price it the: would choose you a pay pleas- to ant known mem- the ory; end? It’s hazy un- til jour- ney’s end.	
3		“When did sor- you rowe- fail cho to fol- bury?”	ows, re- peat- ing a last con- ver- sa- tion at bad mo- ments

Signature Scenes

The Philosopher's Truss. Interlocked stones demand three truths told in sequence: self, companion, stranger. Ordering them well grants a (Guide's Favor) that downshifts ¶osition once/scene on the bridge.

The TollTaker. An old keeper asks for coin, confession, or a scar. Paying grants *Anchored Footing* (ignore one split/shift SB). Cheating the TollTaker ticks Crossing+2.

Mirrored Step. Each PC must answer the other's prompt. On a miss, swap burdens for a scene; the wrong person suffers the costoften revelatory, never lethal.

Bridge Climax Options

tem **Leap of Fellowship:** Combine efforts (group action) to bridge a missing span. On cost, one PC leaves something behind (gear, memory, or favor). tem **Answer in Deed:** Resolve a party member's step by acting it out now. Grants a group (Shared Vow) usable once per part. tem **Summon a Way:** Magic shapes a temporary stone. It lasts exactly as long as the caster holds their breath in honesty.

Part II The Sunken City of SevenSorrows (Tier IIIIV)

Frame

Seven districts embody seven kinds of sorrow. Each solved sorrow weakens the rift and lowers the Orrery's DV by 1 (to a minimum of 3). Districts invite noncombat problemsolving; violence tends to multiply echoes.

City Timers

tem Rift Instability⁶ (surges close or rotate streets) tem Rival Progress⁶ (shared with Part I) tem Civic Memory⁷ (how much of the city remembers itself)

District Menu (Choose 35)

District of Broken Promises. Doorways recite oaths. *Challenge:* correctly amend an oath to include true limits. *SB:* doors bargain with rivals. *Reward:* (Right of Passage) through any one sealed portal.

Quarter of Final Regrets. Plazas show last choices. *Challenge:* stage a reenactment with a different ending that *could* have been. *Failforward:* the crowd insists on an encore at the worst time.

Hall of Unfinished Songs. Melodies lack final lines. *Challenge:* complete a refrain that heals rather than conquers. *Magic:* resonant spells can take the melody's shape. *Reward:* reduce Rift Instability².

Market of Unsent Letters. Stalls sell words never mailed. *Challenge:* purchase the right unsent letter and deliver it to a living recipient. *Cost:* you must leave an unsent letter of your own. *Reward:* (Bearer's Seal).

Gardens of No Farewell. Plants grow from farewells withheld. *Challenge:* prune without killing: a careful Position test. *SB:* roots entangle gear; lose something symbolic.

Tower of Abandoned Vows. Steps climb but do not descend; each level asks a vow renewed or released. *Challenge:* name what continues, and what ends. *Reward:* (Clear Conscience): once, ignore a social taboo's penalty.

Drowned Forum. Debate pits beneath shallow black water. *Challenge:* argue submerged; breath sets the tempo. *Reward:* set crowd mood for next public scene; reduce by 1 for a debate.

The Orrery of Lost Worlds (Finale)

A chamber of spheres, rings, and chains, orbiting a blank star. Start at DV 6; each district solved reduces DV by 1. Three *Pillars* hold the mechanism in fate:

tem **Axis of Names.** The city remembers who it was. *Counter:* place true names recovered from letters and songs. tem **Weights of Debt.** Tallies of bargains hold the orbits. *Counter:* cancel or forgive a meaningful debt onscreen. tem **Gnomon of Return.** A shadowmark sets the city's angle. *Counter:* align with the Bridge's rhythm (Shared Vow, Guide's Favor, or a sacrificial pause).

Outcomes

tem **Seal the Rift:** The city stabilizes as a twilight district accessible by rite. Each PC chooses one sorrow they have *truly* laid down; gain a lingering boon. tem **Map the Paths:** The Orrery points to other lost places. Rivals depart rich; you earn routes and obligations. tem **Offer to a Patron:** Trade the Orrery's motion for a boon. The city changes and so does the world nearby.

NPC Roster (QuickUse)

rule	Name	Desires, Lever- age, Tell, Voice
rule	Captain Brann of the Black Ferrule	Contracts; ex- plo- sives, an- chors; boots scrape stone; blunt, sol- dierly.
	Sister Ysol of the Last Dawn	Purity; sacra- ment wards; ashsmudge rit- ual; fer- vent, pre- cise.
	Cartographer Pell of the Gulls	Knowledge; par- tial charts; hums while plot- ting; ea- ger, scat- tered.
linewidth		Toll paid; rules of pas- sage; weighs your words; winddry, pa-
	The TollTaker	

A Session 1 (Bridge) 3 Hours

tem **Arrival (15 min)**: Establish why each PC must cross. Show a visible Diamond (Guide's Favor hint). tem **First Five Steps (45 min)**: Mix prompts 13. Offer a failforward that grants a temporary boon with a cost. tem **Pressure Beat (30 min)**: Wind shift splits the line; group action to reunite or pay a Toll. tem **SetPiece (3040 min)**: Philosopher's Truss; earn Guide's Favor or tick Crossing+2. tem **CamponAir (10 min)**: On fatigue, rest with a choice of coin, confession, or scar.

B Printable Timers

Crossing8fill

Rival Progress6fill Rival Lead3fill

Rift Instability6fill

Civic Memory7fill

Appendix C: PlayerFacing Handouts

Crossing Rights. “The bridge admits those who answer in deed. Pay with what weighs you most.”

Sorrow Map (Text). A circular diagram of seven districts; connect any three to weaken the Orrery.

Steps Into Sorrow A Fate's Edge adventure.

C GM Enhancements Overview

labelapp:enhancements **Included options:**

tem **XP milestone awards** for character progression. tem **Magic path specializations** tailored to each district challenge. tem **Expanded failforward examples** for tricky bridge steps. tem **Position shift guidelines** for usage.

D XP Progression Milestones (Total: 5490 XP)

rule Milestone	XP Award	Triggers When
rule Bridge Completion	+12 XP	Entire party reaches Sev-en-Sor-rows
District Solution	+6 XP	Each of first 3 dis-tricts re-solved
Sorrow Mastery	+8 XP	4+ dis-tricts solved or ma-jor echo paci-fied
Orrery Access	+10 XP	Chambers un-locked (be-fore fi-nale)
Final Resolution	+15 XP	Orrery out-come achieved
Session Base	+6 XP	Per ses-sion (ex-plo-ration, role-play, set-backs)
tomrule	11	

E Magic Path Integration by District

labelapp:magicbydistrict

DistrictSpecific Advantages

rule District	Magic Path Ben- e- fits
rule Broken Promises	<i>Runekeepers:</i> Pa- tron's au- thor- ity can com- pel door com- pli- ance (+1 Ef- fect). <i>In- vok- ers:</i> Sym- bols re- veal which oaths were to which pa- trons.
Final Regrets	<i>Casters:</i> El- e- men- tal magic can re- shape reen- act- ments (Fire for pas- sion, Wa-

F FailForward Reference (Bridge Steps)

labelapp:failforward

Expanded Consequences

rule Step	PartMiss Suc-(2 cess Boons (1 + BoonCost)
rule Promise Binding	RecallNow who be- you comes madeau- it di- to; ble gain to +1 ri- die vals; vs they that can per- use son it against you
Price of Knowledge	LearnForesee the a ques-com- tion'sade's ori- po- gin; ten- gain tial lore demise; ad- Dread van- +2 tage
Unburied Failure	EchoEcho ap- merges pearswith but a of- ri- fers val; use- they ful gain memyour
linewidth	o- man- ries ner- isms
Overused Tool	Recognize de- be- pen- comes dencyen- next tient use and gainsre- +1 fuses Ef- cer-

G Diamond Position Shifts Quick Reference

	rule Diamond	Position Shift	Limitations
	rule Guide's Favor	Desperate & Controlled	Once per bridge segment; must help another traveler
	Right of Passage	Controlled & Dominant	Single portal; expires at sunset
	Bearer's Seal	Controlled & Dominant (social)	Only for delivery missions; recipient must be living
labelapp:diamonds linewidth	Shared Vow	Group +1 Position step	All participants must uphold vow terms
	Clear Conscience	Ignore taboo penalty	One use; must be narrated

H Part I Aids The Bridge of a Thousand Steps (Tier II)

labelapp:bridgeaids

Enhanced Magic Interactions

Step Solutions by Path:

tem *Runekeepers*: Invoke patron rites to answer stepscounts as “deed” but marks +1 Obligation. tem *Casters*: Elemental magic can create temporary handholds/footholdsprovides +1 die but risks backlash on 1s. tem *Invokers*: Symbol display allows ritual answerslower but safer (no Toll on failure). tem *Cantors*: Songs can answer melodic steps automaticallybut attract sorrowecho audience. tem *Summoners*: Spirits can test steps firstLeash ticks instead of PC paying cost.

XP Triggers Part I

tem **Each 2 steps solved**: +2 XP (max +10 XP for bridge) tem **Philosopher’s Truss success**: +4 XP tem **Toll paid meaningfully**: +3 XP (confession/scar > coin) tem **Mirrored Step resolved**: +3 XP per pair tem **Bridge completion**: +12 XP (total Part I: 32 XP)

I Part II Aids The Sunken City of SevenSorrows (Tier IIIIV)

labelapp:sorrowsaids

Magic Path Finale Advantages

Orrery Pillars Path Specializations:

tem **Axis of Names**: Runekeepers/Invokers gain +2 dice (patron connections). tem **Weights of Debt**: Casters can manipulate with elemental balance (+1 Effect). tem **Gnomon of Return**: Cantors/Summoners align with rhythm (+1 Position).

XP Triggers Part II

tem **Each district solved**: +6 XP (max +42 XP for 7 districts) tem **Rival setback**: +4 XP per major rival obstacle overcome tem **Rift stabilization**: +8 XP (per successful surge calming) tem **Orrery access**: +10 XP tem **Finale resolution**: +15 XP (total Part II: 75 XP)

J Session Planning with XP Sample 3Session Arc

labelapp:sessions

Session 1 (Bridge Start): 18 XP

tem 4 steps solved: +8 XP tem Philosopher’s Truss: +4 XP tem Session base: +6 XP

Session 2 (Bridge End): 20 XP

tem Bridge completion: +12 XP tem Meaningful toll: +3 XP tem Session base: +6 XP

Session 3 (First District): 16 XP

tem District solved: +6 XP tem Rival obstacle: +4 XP tem Session base: +6 XP

K Enhanced NPC Magic Interactions

rule NPC	MagicSpecific Hooks
rule Captain Brann	Respects Rune-keepers with warlock patrons; distrusts “wild” casters
Sister Ysol	Offers sacraments that function as temporary sacrifices for religious magic users
Cartographer Pell	Seeks magical mapping assistance; pays in ritual components
TollTaker	Recognizes pa-

labelapp:npcmagic linewidth

L PlayerFacing Magic Guidelines

labelapp:playermagic **For Casters:** Your magic reacts strongly to sorrowechoes. Backlash may manifest as amplified regrets or temporal echoes.

For Runekeepers: Your patron watches this place closely. Obligation marks may come with visions of the city's past patrons.

For Invokers: Symbols hum with recognition here. Rituals take half time but attract echowitnesses.

For Cantors: Unfinished songs seek completion. Your performances may temporarily heal rift instability.

For Summoners: Spirits behave oddly here. They may remember things from the city's past or refuse certain commands.